Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/gurkimchi (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Barista
Cloud Computing
Distributed Systems

Languages

Hebrew (Native or Bilingual)
English (Native or Bilingual)

Publications

Validation of Vector Data using Oblique Images

Asynchronous Active Browser Cache Management for Efficient and Secure Web Applications

Augmenting a field of view in connection with vision-tracking

Patents

EVENT SERVICE FOR LOCAL CLIENT APPLICATIONS THROUGH LOCAL SERVER

NAVIGATION TO DYNAMIC ENDPOINT

AUGMENTING A FIELD OF VIEW IN CONNECTION WITH VISION-TRACKING

MOBILE DEVICE AS A LOCAL SERVER

EMBEDDED CONTENT PRESENTATION

Gur K.

Husband, Dad (x3), Technologist, Advisor & Board Member, ex. Amazon (Founder of Prime Air), ex. Microsoft, 9 x VC-backed startups (4 x active, 1 x IPO, 3 x exits, 2 x lifelong lessons)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Summary

There are 3 persistent long-term trends I've observed over the last 25 years that guide how I think about strategy & technology: first is that technology (especially in the realm of AI and Robotics) will continue to become more capable and affordable; second that people, while incredibly flexible, will continue to become more expensive and present scale & safety barriers as systems become more complex and remote (this shows up clearly in NTSB data, as one of many examples); and third that organizations that are able to successfully "vertically or horizontally integrate" will compete favorably w/ traditional organizations in the long term - Tesla and Apple as prototypical examples of Vertical Integration, and Boeing and Airbus as examples of Horizontal Integration - obviously Amazon Prime Air was also on that path.

Organizations that don't seriously consider some form of deep integration may struggle to remain competitive in the long run - stating the obvious (but which is too often ignored): what made an organization successful in the past may not be what keeps it competitive in the future.

Experience

Evolved Robotics
Co-Founder & Tech Fellow
March 2025 - Present (1 year 4 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Autonomous Humans > Autonomous Robots

Datablanket
Co-Founder & Board Member
September 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)
Greater Seattle Area

"Digitizing Firefighting"...a real-time AI System-of-Systems + Boots on the Ground for Firefighting — 10X productivity for existing assets while enabling the integration of crewed+uncrewed teaming of autonomous systems. #nomoremegafires!

Stealth Startup
Cofounder & Tech Fellow
April 2024 - Present (2 years 3 months)
United States

Look, it Moves!

Oumi
Advisor
December 2024 - Present (1 year 7 months)
United States

Open Source Trustworthy AI

Claryo, Inc.
Advisor
June 2022 - Present (4 years 1 month)

“Metric” Virtual Twins, Analytics & Real Time Optimization for Commercial B2B Physical Facilities

Aerolane
Cofounder & Non-Executive Chairperson
October 2020 - Present (5 years 9 months)
United States

...AI+TechOps+Robotics middle-mile air-logistics: “the speed of air at the cost of ground” - trains of tractors (almost any modern aircraft) & trailers - in the air!

Near Earth Autonomy
Independent Board Member
October 2021 - Present (4 years 9 months)
Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, United States

...Building the world’s most advance “commercial synthetic pilot” for the UAM, Drone and Defense industries.

New Vista Capital
Venture Partner
February 2021 - Present (5 years 5 months)
Greater Chicago Area

...helping create the next-wave of Aero+Space companies

Otto Aviation
Advisor
August 2022 - Present (3 years 11 months)

Aircraft configuration & manufacturing technology for 50% lower drag, Breguet to the win!

Ascent AeroSystems
5 years 8 months

Adviser and Technical SME
April 2024 - Present (2 years 3 months)
United States

Independent Board Member & Technical Fellow
November 2020 - April 2024 (3 years 6 months)
Greater Boston

Acquired by the Robinson Helicopter Company April 2024.

...A TRL9 commercial true all-weather IMC >98% dispatch-reliability open-systems aircraft system - building the most mature & capable UAS aircraft platform so you don’t have to!

Weel
Advisor
July 2021 - Present (5 years)
Seattle, Washington, United States

...Building Autonomous Robots that look like E-Bikes

NASA - National Aeronautics and Space Administration
Subject Matter Expert - AI, Autonomy, Robotics, and Safety
November 2020 - Present (5 years 8 months)

GSI Technology
Advisor
October 2020 - Present (5 years 9 months)

...Building computational memory technology & hardware platforms to accelerate AI workload (up to) 1000X, or reduce the power needed to run AI workloads (up to) 1000X.

North American Wave Engine Corporation
Advisor
October 2020 - December 2025 (5 years 3 months)
Remote

...Building a FADEC flex-fuel (including hydrogen!) Jet-Engine with zero moving parts and the efficiency of a Williams.

Vertical Aerospace
Independent Board Member & Certification Committee Chair
November 2021 - May 2025 (3 years 7 months)
United Kingdom

The Building Machines Company
Advisor
January 2021 - December 2024 (4 years)
Greater Boston

...Building Robots that construct commercial concrete structures of any kind.

Opteran
Advisor
October 2021 - October 2023 (2 years 1 month)
United Kingdom

...a biologically-inspired high-performance, low-SWaP$ autonomy system for ground & air robots.

HyPoint
Advisor
October 2020 - November 2022 (2 years 2 months)

Acquired by ZeroAvia Nov 2022.

Building next-generation high(er) temperature & pressure fuel-cell systems for large scale aerospace systems.

Federal Aviation Administration
DAC (Drone Advisory Committee) Member
September 2016 - January 2021 (4 years 5 months)

https://www.faa.gov/uas/programs_partnerships/drone_advisory_committee/

Amazon
8 years 1 month

Vice President, Amazon
March 2020 - September 2020 (7 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Vice President, Prime Air
September 2012 - March 2020 (7 years 7 months)

Developing physical packet-based networking using highly-automated robotics.

Vice President, Vendor Systems (+ 2 tech incubations)
September 2012 - March 2014 (1 year 7 months)
Seattle, WA

PNW Wilderness
Barista
September 2012 - September 2012 (1 month)
Bellevue, WA

Catching my breath.

Microsoft
10 years

Partner Engineering Manager
October 2011 - September 2012 (1 year)
Bellevue, WA

Incubating new disruptive technologies within the online services division in the areas of Distributed peer to peer Web-Search and Action-Centric Advertising (e.g "CPA")

Partner Development Manager, Contextual Mobile Search
March 2010 - December 2011 (1 year 10 months)

working on contextual/implicit mobile/geosocial search

Partner Development Manager, MSN/Virtual Earth Core Platform
October 2008 - March 2010 (1 year 6 months)

Partner Development Manager for MSN/Virtual Earth core platform team, runs the dev team working on the platform behind the MSN service (600+ Million users) and Virtual Earth (commercial and consumer platform under SLA).

Software Architect
November 2004 - October 2008 (4 years)

Architect for Microsoft's Virtual Earth effort, co-author of original think-week paper defining the 10 year roadmap/vision, designer of the end to end

software/hardware/operations architecture, technical lead for 4 acquisitions, ~ 25 patents filed during this period, first outdoors container-based server solution in production @ record low PUE, highest tps web service at Microsoft from both egress and transactional capacity, operating at 5-nines+ without failures since the first version.

Lead Program Manager / Tech Lead - Unified Communications
October 2002 - November 2004 (2 years 2 months)

Managed Program Mgmt team that delivered Live Communications Server 2003 and 2005, Delivered the Architecture and Software components that enabled public Presence/IM/VoIP between Enterprises running Live Communications Server and MSN, Yahoo and AOL Messenger Systems, and between Yahoo and MSN Messenger Clouds.

waze
Board Member (representing Microsoft's Investment)
January 2011 - September 2012 (1 year 9 months)

...sold to Google on June 2013 for $1.1B

http://finance.yahoo.com/news/Microsoft-makes-investment-theflyonthewall-3396524324.html

VocalTec
Chief Architect
October 2000 - October 2002 (2 years 1 month)

MacOS Products Dev Lead, later Dev lead on all algorithmic and Network engines, later CTO for TrulyGlobal (a spin-out startup offering rich policy-based multiple points of presence Voice, Video and Messaging Services), later Chief Architect for VocalTec's entire product line.

TrulyGlobal (a VocalTec Spinout)
Chief Technology Officer
August 1998 - October 2000 (2 years 3 months)

VocalTec
3 years 10 months

Development Lead, Algorithms, Network and Media Engines
October 1996 - October 1998 (2 years 1 month)

MacOS Team Lead
January 1995 - October 1996 (1 year 10 months)

Herzliya, Tel Aviv District, Israel

Second ever (after Netscape) Pure-Play Internet IPO

www.nrha.com
NRHA Professional Horse Trainer
January 1988 - October 1995 (7 years 10 months)

Trained Reining Horses , both professional (with myself competing) and non-pro (for my customers). Operated a large facility with 50+ horses, breeding, dozens of customers. Interned at top-10 NRHA trainers (Bob Mac) and was chairman and founder for the first 3 years of the ILRHA . Managed and Chaired the first official AQHA event in Israel.

self employed
Real Time Software, Hardware, Composites, Computational Physics
January 1979 - January 1988 (9 years 1 month)

Sold my first "commercial" software for the Sinclair Spectrum when I was 12... it was a quick game that I wrote while learning BASIC and Z80 assembler... I showed it around, and to my amazment people wanted to pay me for it! At the same time, helped build a Rutan Long-EZ and got infected with the aerospace bug... the rest is history.

Education

School of hard knocks
Learn from failures, Driving TRLs, DfXs, Productivity and OODA loops · (July 1993 - December 1994)